

Signal — Thirdbase Deal Sourcing Agent

Category: Deal intelligence OS for thesis-driven growth investors

One-liner: An always-on sourcing partner that turns fragmented market noise into a self-maintaining deal pipeline, ranked the way Thirdbase actually invests.

Problem

Partners drown in funding announcements, Twitter threads, and associate decks. Coverage tools optimize for volume. Thirdbase needs **judgment**: which deals are genuinely outstanding against thesis, which sectors are emerging before consensus, and what commentary matters — delivered in Excel and email, not another dashboard.

Solution

Signal continuously ingests market signals, deduplicates companies, scores them against Thirdbase investment criteria, maintains a living Excel workbook, sends M/W/F priority digests (plus instant alerts), and answers partner questions with grounded pipeline context.

Users

Role	Job
Partner / Principal	GP Desk, Hot Deals, digest, chat, IC briefs
Associate	Research depth, commentary, sector scans
Anti-user	Anyone who wants infinite unranked lists

Surfaces (Monday path first)

1. **Desk (/)** — Hot Deals, alerts, 60/40, Monday agenda CTA + Excel download
2. **Partner Meeting OS (/meeting)** — auto Monday agenda (~90m)
3. **Excel workbook** (Thirdbase_Deal_Pipeline.xlsx) — primary system of record for debate
4. **Email digest** — Mon / Wed / Fri, hard-capped selectivity (3–5 deals)
5. **Company search (/search)** — pipeline IC briefs; external names are **scout briefs** (Watch-capped)
6. **Conversational agent (/chat)** — grounded Q&A; refuses ungrounded questions
7. **IC / Judgment / Competitors / Library / LP** — supporting governance & intel
8. **Labs (/edge, /os)** — Partner Edge + AI OS demos; not the default Monday path

Immediate alerts — 2+ Tier-1, off-thesis peer moves, GP watchlist / watched-founder hits.

See [COVERAGE.md](#) for the full brief → implementation matrix.

Partner explanation call: [docs/FEATURE_GUIDE.md](#) — every module, use, and talking points.

Competitive research: [docs/AGENTIC_VC_LANDSCAPE.md](#)

Competitor / peer-set intelligence

Implements the brief's **Peer set tracking** + comps — then layers a **golden insights OS** partners actually use:

- Auto-generated partner competitor brief (copyable) with Must-do / Watch
- Proprietary windows (quiet tape + high conviction)
- Crowding / competitive race alerts on Deep Dives
- White-space vs flood theme posture vs peer capital
- Syndicate unlock call lists (heatmap + theme fit)
- Firm battle cards (how they win / weak / partner-or-compete / when to call)
- Circling competitors on every company brief
- Excel **Golden Insights** + **Peer Firm Dossiers** tabs
- Chat: “What should I do Monday?”, proprietary windows, white space, who to call
- Thesis-shift demos for a16z / Sequoia / Ribbit / Tiger

Judgment OS (X-factor — hard to copy)

The layer that separates Signal from “chatbot + table” demos:

1. **Override ledger** — partners disagree with Signal on any company; reasons become policy fuel by scoring dimension (raise/lower bar), not silent fine-tunes
2. **Miss retrospective** — blameless postmortems when breakout velocity or peer FOMO arrives after Signal stayed cool
3. **Mix drift alarm** — 60/40 soft (± 6) and hard (± 12) bands with counsel
4. **Evidence freshness SLA** — field-level age vs SLA; automatic confidence haircut on stale briefs
5. **Founder radar** — watched operators / stealth newcos from GP chatter (never waits for Wednesday)
6. **Digest selectivity A/B** — 3 vs 5 vs 8 deal caps with precision proxy; refuse coverage creep
7. **IC packet export** — one-click markdown IC packet with comps, commentary, peer context, freshness

Surfaces: `/judgment` · company override panel · Excel **Judgment OS** tab · chat (“founder radar”, “what did we miss?”, “judgment OS”)

Partner Edge (demo wow — partners use Monday)

Unique surfaces coverage tools and agentic CRMs rarely ship as a first-class OS:

1. **Anti-consensus radar** — proprietary quiet tape vs consensus traps (peer FOMO > thesis)
2. **Conviction clocks** — FOMO index vs patience- α with act / race / patience / cool-off counsel

- 3. **Partner twin** — judgment DNA from override ledger predicting lean-in / push-back / hard-pass
- 4. **Reference-call factory** — copyable scripts from weak score dims + bear landmines (never auto-send)
- 5. **Thesis what-if** — live reweight of scoring dims → who enters/exits Deep Dive
- 6. **Pass autopsy** — Passes with peer/Tier-1 tension worth reopening before they become miss retros
- 7. **Velocity board** — accelerating names (fresh signal × hiring × commentary)
- 8. **Pre-mortem theater** — “assume we invested and lost” failure modes for IC

Surfaces: /edge · chat (“partner edge”, “conviction clock”, “reference call”, “pre-mortem”)

Sector of Tomorrow

Contrarian + emerging subsectors with evidence (GP chatter, hiring, research velocity, fund formation). Chat filters to AI Infrastructure—parented calls for “*three AI infra sub-sectors nobody is talking about.*”

Investment criteria (encoded in config/thesis_policy.yaml)

- **60%** Dominant tech + growth stage / **40%** Tactical sector-agnostic
- Attractive entry valuation vs sector × stage comps
- High YoY growth (target **40%+** at growth stage)
- ~3 years runway
- 3–4 Tier-1 investors preferred
- High moat / technical defensibility
- TAM > \$1B, 3–5 year exit horizon

Recommendations: **Deep Dive** / **Watch** / **Pass**, with relative rank within theme × stage.

Workbook tabs

Pipeline · Hot Deals · Watchlist · Sector of Tomorrow · Peer Set Activity · Co-investor Heatmap · Golden Insights · Peer Firm Dossiers · Judgment OS · News Worth Reading · Investor Commentary · Stale

Stale entries (≥90 days no signal) are flagged for **partner review** — never auto-deleted.

MVP vs production

MVP	Production
Seed corpus + EDGAR / HN / RSS adapters	PitchBook, Crunchbase, Harmonic, Coresignal
Local SQLite + Excel regen	SharePoint sync, Affinity writeback
Streamlit chat	Always-on workers + SSO

Interview line: We built the judgment layer and partner workflow first. Databases plug in as connectors.

Principles

1. Signal, not coverage
2. Explain every score
3. Relative ranking within cohort
4. Confidence + provenance on every field
5. Human-in-the-loop on destructive actions
6. Excel is a feature
7. Thesis is config, not code

Phase 2 roadmap

- Paid deal-database connectors
- Coresignal hiring feeds
- Continuous cloud ingest
- Affinity / Attio writeback
- SharePoint-hosted live workbook
- Diligence Stress Pack v2: PDF deck upload (OCR), pwMOIC scenarios, Affinity warm-path graph